

AI Policy

For the purpose of this policy, we define Artificial Intelligence (AI) as computer systems and tools capable of performing tasks that typically require human intelligence. This includes both traditional AI systems (used for analysis, recommendation and decision-making) and generative AI, which creates new content like text, images, audio or video. With the explosion of generative AI, we recognize its potential to dramatically improve the quality of our work, ignite creativity, streamline processes and grow audiences. We are committed to responsibly and safely integrating AI tools into our work across all platforms at SJC

Scope

Upholding content integrity and customer trust are our top priorities. Our AI approach is aligned with SJC's purpose to inform, inspire and empower through best-in-class content and storytelling as well with our core values of curiosity, innovation and community well-being. This policy applies to all SJC staff and freelancers using AI tools for published content, including on behalf of clients, across both Content and Media platforms and all our Media brands: *Canadian Business*, *Chatelaine*, *Châtelaine*, *FASHION*, *HELLO! Canada*, *Maclean's*, *Today's Parent* and *Toronto Life*.

Principles

- **Integrity First:** We prioritize human judgment, ethical considerations and factual accuracy above all else.
- **Transparency:** We believe in clear disclosure of AI use in content.
- **Human Oversight:** We require human review as well as fact-checking and editorial approval for all AI-generated content.
- **Curiosity and Learning:** We encourage our team to stay updated on AI technologies, explore new applications and participate in training regarding AI.
- **Sharing and Collaborating:** We encourage staff to share what they learn about AI with their colleagues, to ask questions and to collaborate on AI integrations and opportunities.

Guidelines

- **AI in Writing:** We may use AI for specific tasks like ideation, brainstorming, research, outlining and copywriting but not for the actual writing of articles without clear disclosure.
- **AI-Generated Images & Video:** SJC currently prohibits using AI to generate photography and video for news and current affairs. For creative visuals, we require clear disclosure and human oversight throughout the process.
- **Purposeful Integration:** At SJC, we believe in using AI tools strategically to enhance efficiency, depth, creativity and the customer experience. Examples include:

- o Research: Identifying trends and patterns in large datasets.
 - o Content Creation Assistance: Brainstorming ideas, suggesting headlines, summarizing long documents and generating translations.
 - o Content Optimization: Improving search engine optimization (SEO) and personalizing content recommendations.
 - o Data Handling: Summarizing and structuring complex data for analysis and reporting.
 - o Business Operations: Preparing presentations, researching and copy editing.
 - o Content Creation: AI personas, video, animation, environments, retouching and blends.
- **Approved Tools:** We encourage responsible exploration of AI tools. Associates must first obtain approval from their manager before using any new AI tool. Managers, in turn, must ensure the proposed tool undergoes assessment by the IT department regarding confidentiality and privacy features before granting final approval for its use.
 - **Human Review:** SJC requires human review and approval before any AI-generated content is published.
 - **Disclosure:** We are committed to transparency with our readers, clients and associates. Our approach to disclosure varies depending on the context. For editorial content, we disclose AI use in any published work, whether it be written or visual, explaining how it was used. For commercial work performed for clients, we disclose the use of AI tools or processes directly to the relevant client.
 - **Monitoring & Reporting:** Any suspected or confirmed concerns related to generative AI usage should be reported promptly to SJC's IT team.
 - **Freelancers:** Whenever working with freelancers and similar third parties, we clearly communicate these expectations to them and ensure they understand and adhere to our AI usage guidelines.
 - **Client Policies:** We encourage any clients to share their AI-related brand guidelines or ethical policies to consider their legal and corporate rules.

Guardrails

- **Data Privacy:** We ensure all data used with AI tools adheres to our data privacy policies and ethical guidelines. We never enter confidential or personally identifiable information (PII) relating to our clients, staff, sources or readers into AI tools.
- **Tool Evaluation:** We are required to evaluate the security of AI tools before accessing and using them. This includes ensuring that the tool is reputable and well established and reviewing the tool's terms of service, privacy policy and security features.
- **Hallucinations:** We acknowledge that AI models can sometimes produce inaccurate outputs. We critically evaluate and verify all AI-generated outputs with reliable sources.

- **Bias:** We are vigilant against potential biases in AI systems. We carefully evaluate outputs for fairness and balance.
- **Plagiarism, Intellectual Property and Copyright:** We verify the origin of source material and ensure that AI-generated content doesn't infringe on copyright or intellectual property rights. If we have any doubt, we don't publish the content. At all times, we respect and protect intellectual property rights of all persons, internally and externally. Unauthorized use of materials or content creation that violates the rights of others is not excusable.
- **Proprietary Journalism:** We safeguard our original work. We don't enter published work or substantial portions into open-source AI models or public platforms.

Shaping the Future of AI

Spreading Awareness: SJC is eager to collaborate with other organizations, including our clients, to foster innovation and responsible AI regulation. We use our platform to champion responsible AI development and advocate for widespread AI literacy.

Safe and Secure Use

- **Authorized Access:** Access to generative AI tools, platforms or related systems should be restricted to authorized personnel only. We don't share our access credentials or allow unauthorized individuals to use the generative AI tools on our behalf.
- **Safe Configuration:** Generative AI tools and platforms must be configured securely, following industry best practices and vendor recommendations. This includes ensuring the latest updates, patches, and security fixes are applied in a timely manner.
- **User Authentication:** Strong authentication mechanisms, such as multi-factor authentication (MFA), should be implemented for accessing generative AI tools and platforms. Passwords we use for access should be unique, complex and changed regularly.
- **Logging and Auditing:** Appropriate mechanisms should be implemented to capture activities related to generative AI usage. These logs should be regularly reviewed by the IT Department to detect and respond to any suspicious or unauthorized activities.
- **Vulnerability Management:** Regular vulnerability assessments and security testing should be conducted by the IT Department on generative AI tools and platforms to identify and address any security weaknesses or vulnerabilities.
- **Use of Work Accounts:** Logins to generative AI tools and platforms must be made exclusively using official work-provided email accounts. Personal email accounts are not permitted for access.

Other SJC policies and laws

All other company policies, including SJC's data privacy policy, information technology security related policies, confidentiality obligations and beyond apply to the use of AI within SJC and on behalf of our brands. All associates are required to comply with the laws as well as other company policies in addition to this policy, as it relates to AI. For example, our data

privacy policy, information technology security related policies, confidentiality obligations and beyond, should not be compromised in any way to make room for AI in our workplace.

Resources and Support

We will be educating our associates, including freelancers, where applicable, with the knowledge and skills to use AI tools responsibly and effectively. We will also have forums to share learnings and ask questions. It is up to each of us to take AI exploration into our own hands, so actively and regularly seek information and learning opportunities.

Non-Compliance

Non-compliance with this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or contract, and legal consequences if applicable laws are violated.

Continuous Review and Updates

This is a living document, subject to regular review and updates to reflect evolving AI technology and our learnings. Staff feedback is welcome and encouraged. Questions from our external audiences can be directed to sjc.connect@stjoseph.com.